



△ Mil Mi-8 1961

Origin USSR

Engine 2 x 1,700 shp Izotov TV2-117A turboshaft

Top speed 180 mph (290 km/h)

Successful as a military assault helicopter, the Mi-8 also flew civilian passenger services with Soviet airline Aeroflot. One variant had 32 seats and a toilet.



△ Mil Mi-2 1961

Origin Poland

Engine 2 x 400 shp Isotov GTD-350 turboshaft

Top speed 124 mph (200 km/h)

Although of Russian design, this was Poland's most successful helicopter. More than 5,200 twin-turbine Mi-2s were built in 24 military and civilian variants.



▽ Hughes OH-6A 1965

Origin US

Engine 317 shp Allison T63-A5A turboshaft

Top speed 175 mph (281 km/h)

Successful in military and civilian worlds, the "Loach" was designed as a Vietnam-era light observation helicopter and set 23 world records for speed, endurance, and rate of climb.

△ Hughes 269C 1969

Origin US

Engine 190 hp Lycoming HIO-360-D1A

Top speed 109 mph (175 km/h)

The small piston-engined Hughes, first flown in 1955, reached its zenith with the 269C. Its larger rotor and more powerful engine improved performance by almost 50 percent.



▽ Kamov Ka-25PL 1965

Origin USSR

Engine 2 x 900 shp Glushenkov GTD-3F turboshaft

Top speed 130 mph (209 km/h)

Designed for Soviet Navy antisubmarine work, the Ka-25s folding, coaxial contrarotating main blades kept dimensions tight to allow for shipboard storage.



▷ Bensen B-8M

Gyroplane 1960

Origin UK

Engine 72 hp McCulloch 4318 2-stroke

Top speed 85 mph (137 km/h)

Developed from an unpowered rotor kite, in the 1950s, the B-8M set many records for speed, distance, and altitude. Out of production since 1987, the Gyroplane is popular with homebuilders.

